



PAMANTASAN NG LUNGSOD NG VALENZUELA

The Effect of Credibility of AI-Generated Business Content on Communication Strategies

Among Coffee Shop Owners and Managers in CAMANAVA

A Marketing Research Paper Presented to the Faculty of the College of Accountancy and

Business Administration

In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the Degree of Bachelor of Science in Business

Administration Major in Marketing Management

BSBA MM 2-9

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MARCH 2026



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CHAPTER 1

Background of The Study/ Introduction

Rapid advances in artificial intelligence (AI) have dramatically changed how corporations create, manage, and disseminate communication content. AI-generated business content refers to marketing and promotional content produced by AI tools, such as automated copywriting systems, chatbots and content generating platforms. Shorter time to develop marketing communications, lesser effort and more consistent communication outputs have been driving smaller and medium sized firms to increase technology adoption. Coffee shop businesses in the food and beverage industry are already using AI-generated content for social media promotions, product advertising and customer interaction techniques.

The release of the National AI Strategy Roadmap (NAISR 2.0) 2025 has pushed the discourse on Artificial Intelligence in the Philippines from the realm of speculative futurism to that of serious policy-making. The Filipino population has already exhibited tremendous grassroots adoption of these tools, ranking among the world's leaders in per capita usage of ChatGPT, while the government strives to bridge infrastructure gaps. The challenge for business now is not so much the acquisition of technology but the efficiency of AI to not undermine the relationship background of the Filipino consumer experience.





A rising AI Ad Gap has also become apparent in the U.S., with a tendency among executives to focus on automated marketing usually conflicting with consumer preferences to have human authenticity (Chin et al., 2025). Conversely, India is as well in the lead of global optimism concerning AI adaptation, but at the same time, it is going through a regulatory re- boot to deal with AI-created fake news in its financial services industry (Upadhyay, 2026). Meanwhile, nations like Japan and Finland also possess the lowest level of trust in the world, and users will be inclined to assume that AI-assisted business-generated content fails to show social responsibility. In Brazil and South Africa, the discussion is centered on the ethics of AI, where the effectiveness of robotic communication is a consideration against the risk of undermining the brand-to-customer relationships that have been well nurtured over a long time (Panicachi & Cohen, 2024).

Locally, AI content is mostly used by the Micro, tiny and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs), especially in the business hubs of Metro Manila, Cebu and Davao to address the tiny marketing budgets. Local business owners are utilizing AI to create proposals to clients, even advertising brochures (Brobio & Amoguis, 2025). This however resulted to a recorded credibility decrease in local trade. Business owners in these areas have argued that AI technologies have failed to grasp local nuances, dialectical nuances or the warmth that should be generated in Filipino business talks, and that has resulted in a loss of client trust. Local economies are close knit and the apparent laziness of employing unedited AI materials is now the new benchmark of a company's professionalism and reliability."The use of artificial intelligence (AI) in business communication has changed the way





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businesses develop and distribute marketing content. SMEs are increasingly using AI-powered business content to enhance their promotional tactics, client interaction and branding efforts.

The coffee shop in CAMANAVA is in a very competitive sector and employs communication to attract and retain consumers. As more and more firms use AI tools to create content, it is crucial to understand how views of the trustworthiness of AI impact strategic decisions in communications. The purpose of this study is to fill this vacuum by analyzing the relationship between the trustworthiness of AI-generated business content and communication tactics employed by coffee shop owners and the managers.

The purpose of this study is to investigate the effect of credibility of AI-generated business content on the communication strategies of coffee shop owners and managers in CAMANAVA.





Theoretical Framework / Research Paradigm

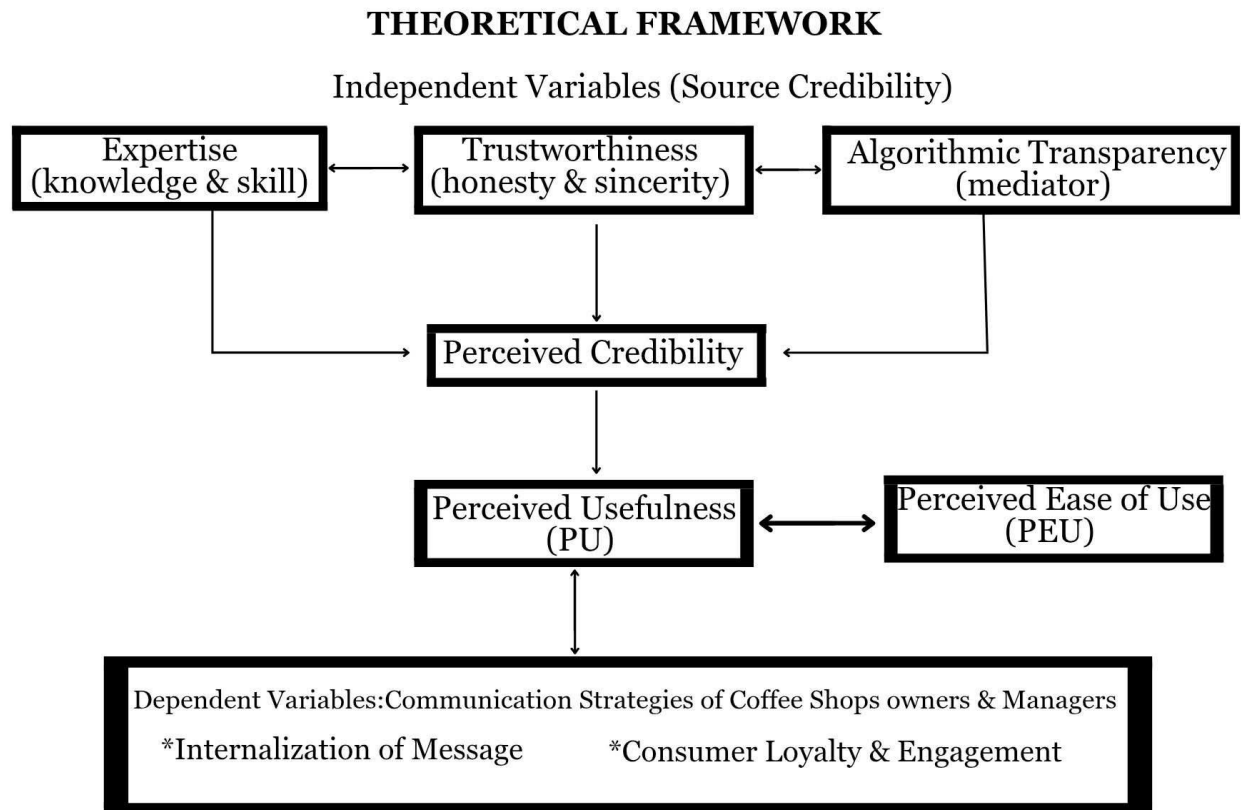


Figure 1. *Modified Source Credibility Model to fit the context of Artificial Intelligence by substituting Physical Attractiveness with Algorithmic Transparency.*

The theoretical framework of this study is primarily anchored on Source Credibility Theory by Hovland, et al. (1953). The theory explains that the receiver's perception of the source's expertise and trustworthiness determines the persuasiveness of the communication source. In the context of this study the coffee shop owner or manager around the CAMANAVA area is the "source" that produces business content using AI





tools. To bridge the gap between "believing the content" (credibility) and "acting on the content" (communication strategy) TAM 3 was further extended by integrating it as a supporting theory. The Source Credibility Model was modified to fit the context of Artificial Intelligence by substituting Physical Attractiveness with Algorithmic Transparency as the third variable of credibility that is needed for business stakeholders due to the unique requirements posed by non-human communication sources.

This theory states that the respondents are more likely to accept the message if they see the source as knowledgeable and trustworthy (Hovland et al. 1953). In this study, expertise is defined as the perceived knowledge and skill of the communicator, while trustworthiness refers to the perceived honesty and sincerity. Instead of including physical attractiveness, this model uses algorithmic transparency to better fit AI-generated content. This modified set of independent variables expertise, trustworthiness, and transparency shapes how credible coffee shop owners or managers are perceived. This credibility is a precursor to the perceived usefulness (PU) and perceived ease of use (PEU) that together influence the effectiveness of the dependent variables. This credibility affects how useful and easy the information is to understand, which ultimately leads to better communication, stronger customer engagement, and increased loyalty.

This theory is the main lens through which the effects of AI-generated content on the relationship between coffee shops and their customers can be understood. The study investigates whether AI is seen by owners and managers as credible enough for their





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business or if the content seems insincere and unrealistic, focusing on Expertise, Trustworthiness, and Algorithmic Transparency, which alters the way people engage with automation by reducing perceived risk and enhancing competence beliefs, frequently mediating the relationship between technical algorithmic features and user behavior by Kartik Hosanagar, & Jair, V. (2018) in lieu of a non-human source. Supporting theory, TAM 3, is used to bridge the gap between credibility and communication strategy and to examine how the Perceived Usefulness (PU) and Ease of Use (EU) of AI influence a manager's decision to trust and adopt these technologies by Venkatesh and Bala (2008). These frameworks by synthesizing provide a practical guide for coffee shop owners in the CAMANAVA area to strengthen their business strategies so it remains credible, convincing, honest and effective in an internet based market.





Conceptual Framework

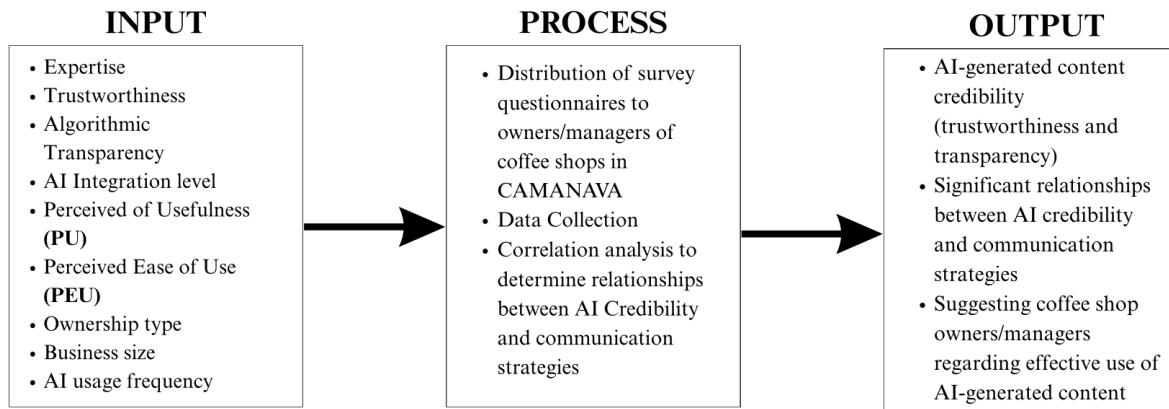


Figure 2. *The Input-Process-Output Model of Modified Source Credibility Theory Integrated with TAM 3*

This study uses an input-process-output framework to analyze the effects of AI-generated content credibility on communication strategies among coffee shop owners/managers in CAMANAVA. The input consists of respondents' profile information regarding their business size, years using AI, years of AIGC used in their business, and frequency of using AI-generated content in customer interaction. Other variables to be examined are expertise, trustworthiness, algorithmic transparency, level of AI integration, and TAM variables which consist of Perceived Usefulness (PU) and Perceived Ease of Use (PEU). The process includes questionnaire distribution, data collection, and analysis of the data collected through correlation analysis. It identifies the respondents' profiles in relation to the business size, years using AI, duration of AIGC usage, and frequency of AIGC usage in customer interaction. Then, the level of AI-generated business content's credibility based





on expertise and trustworthiness will be measured. Also the level of algorithmic transparency among respondents will be investigated. Moreover, the study also identifies the level of communication strategies used in AI-generated contents. Lastly, it analyzes the impact of acceptance and use of AI in business communication.

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to examine the effect of the credibility of AI-generated business content on the communication strategies of coffee shop owners and managers in the CAMANAVA area.

In particular, it aims to address the following questions:

1. What is the Business profile of the respondents in the following:

1.1 Business size;

1.2 Years of AI usage;

1.3 Duration of AIGC utilization in business operations;

1.4 Frequency of AIGC use in customer interactions?

2. What is the level of credibility of AI-generated business content in terms of:

2.1 Expertise;

2.2 Trustworthiness?

3. What is the level of perceived algorithmic transparency of AI-generated business content among the respondents?





4. What is the level of communication strategies regarding:

4.1 Quality of Content;

4.2 Message consistency;

4.3 Audience engagement?

5. Is there a significant relationship between AI credibility and communication strategies?

Scope and Delimitation

The main area of this research is focused on the assessment of the use of digital technologies in coffee shop companies in the CAMANAVA area (Caloocan, Malabon, Navotas, and Valenzuela) that have been using AICG for more than a year. From the perspective of these particular urban businesses, this study examines the impact of long-term automation on how authentic and “warmth” customer engagement by promoting the development of a strong and ethical digital culture for small businesses. The scope of this research is specifically defined to establish a localized basis for Target 9.b, with the aim of supporting domestic technology development and promoting a transparent and trustworthy digital economy in the Philippines. In particular, the study aims at a sample size of at least 60 to 80 coffee shop owners or managers to come up with a strong dataset to be analyzed quantitatively with recommendations of Labajová (2023). The rationale behind choosing a sample size of 60 to 80 respondents is patterned on its appropriateness for quantitative analysis while remaining attainable within the study’s scope and delimitation. This sample size provides sufficient variability response without compromising the data quality.





Furthermore, it is supported by the study of Labajová (2023), which utilized a comparable survey approach to analyze the users' perceptions, credibility, and trust in AI-generated content, supporting the appropriateness of the selected sample size for providing an eligible and reliable data result.

Significance of the Study

The result of the study will benefit the following groups:

Business Practitioners. This research provides business practitioners with an empirical foundation to enhance both the proficiency and quality of AI-generated content within their marketing workflows. The study helps the professionals to create the communications plan that would protect the trust of customers against the automation risks by claiming the importance of transparency. It presents a pragmatic model of constructing messages that build brand perceptions without causing the AI tools to be misapplied and unethical. In the end, the practitioners will be able to utilize these insights to ensure that technological efficiency is aligned to the high-standard of credibility of contemporary business processes.

Technology Developers. To developers of AI tools, the present paper points to the existent critical challenge of the so-called Trust Paradox during the implementation of global technologies in localized, collectivist communities such as the Philippines. Developers can use these findings to perfect AI "voices" and algorithmic sincerity, moving beyond mere technical precision toward cultural resonance. This alignment with SDG 9 (Innovation) ensures that the next generation of business tools is designed with the ethical and relational sensitivities of the Global South in mind.





Consumers. Consumers benefit from this study through the promotion of more transparent, ethical, and high-quality digital interactions with their favorite local brands. The study proposes a soft infrastructure of communication, which consists in focusing on truthfulness and honesty, safeguarding the citizens against propagating fake information or spamming spam. When the findings of this research are applied by businesses operating in the CAMANAVA area, consumers will be served in an inclusive and responsive environment that honors their cultural values and the need to feel that genuine connection.

Students in Business Administration. The study provides Business Administration learners with a critical insight into how the perception of integrity and credibility of contemporary organisations are affected by AI-generated content. It is an effective academic tool that instructors may use to augment business and communication programs with experience about the changing digital world. By highlighting the intersection of AI ethics and digital literacy, the study prepares future professionals to manage credibility control in increasingly automated corporate environments. Ultimately, it provides students with a foundational framework for applying contemporary technological strategies while upholding the high standards of stakeholder trust.

Business Owners (CAMANAVA). This research offers coffee shop owners in the CAMANAVA area a practical roadmap for adopting artificial intelligence while maintaining the heartfelt service characteristic of Filipino culture. It provides actionable insights on how to utilize automated tools to improve operational speed without losing the personal touch that builds local community trust. By identifying the specific factors that drive consumer acceptance, the study helps managers select AI applications that resonate





with the emotional expectations of their patrons. Consequently, business owners can achieve a harmonious balance between technological innovation and the sincere, human-centered hospitality that ensures long-term brand success.

Marketing Professionals. This study serves as a fundamental guide to the marketing practitioner charged with the role of orchestrating automation and authenticity in the high context cultures. It offers empirical evidence on how urban Filipino demographics differentiate between helpful automation and "robotic insincerity," allowing marketers to refine their tone and delivery. Through the knowledge of the parameters of the Source Credibility, professionals are able to create better communication strategies that can be used to scale production using generative AI without the need to undermine brand equity.

Future Researchers. This study establishes a foundational localized framework that bridges the gap between traditional organizational theories and modern AI-human interaction. It provides future scholars with an empirical basis for investigating the long-term psychological effects of automated branding in the Southeast Asian context. By documenting the evolution of TAM in the 2026 digital landscape, this research opens new academic pathways for exploring how emerging technologies can be governed by human-centric trust and sustainable industrial standards.





REVIEW ON RELATED LITERATURE

Artificial Intelligence in Business Communication

The rapid development of artificial intelligence (AI) has significantly changed the business community in a way that it can automate content creation, personalize customer interactions, and enhance efficiency. According to the study of Davenport, Guha, Grewal, and Bressgott (2020), they explained that artificial intelligence driven technologies enable organizations to generate data-driven messages that improve marketing effectiveness and operational productivity. However, the researchers also warned that the excessive use of artificial intelligencemaypotentially weaken authenticity, thus potentially reducing the trust of the consumers.

Huang and Rust (2021), further argued that artificial intelligence services delivery through speed, scalability, and personalization but lacks the emotional intelligence, which is critical for trust development. Their findings suggest that although artificial intelligence improves the efficiency of work, human involvement remains essential to preserve the empathy and credibilityinthecommunication.

Similarly, Chatterjee, Rana, Tamilmani, and Sharma (2021) states that artificial intelligence-based communication increases the engagement and personalization but it also heightens the manipulation and ethical misuse. Consumers become skeptical when communication appears overly automated, which therefore leads to diminished credibility. Dwivedi et al. (2021) emphasized trust, perceived usefulness, and ease of use significantly influence user acceptance of artificial intelligence communication tools. Their findings





indicate that businesses must design an artificial intelligence that are transparent, reliable, ethically aligned in order to foster trust.

Trust and Credibility in AI- Generated Business Content

Trust and credibility remains a fundamental element of effective business communication. In the study of Morgan and Hunt (2021), they reaffirmed that trust forms the foundation of long-term business relationships that directly influences the customer's loyalty and engagement. In an artificial intelligence mediated environment, trust becomes more complex due to the algorithmic design decision-making and reduced human presence. Longoni, Bonezzi, and Morewedge (2021) found that the consumers often distrust artificial intelligence generated content, particularly when it comes to subjective domains such as marketing and customer service. This phenomenon is known as algorithm aversion, occurs when individuals perceive artificial intelligence outputs as lacking empathy and moral reasoning.

When a human-written and artificial intelligence- generated news content, concluding that human- authored messages are perceived as more emotionally credible, while artificial intelligence is rated higher when it comes to clarity and objectivity. These findings highlight the importance of emotional intelligence in establishing trust (Wölker and Powell, 2021).

Forbes Advisor (2025) reported that although the consumers recognize the efficiency of using artificial intelligence, concerns about misinformation and impersonality persist. This





underscores the importance of credibility safeguards and verification process in artificial intelligence driven business communication.

Consumer Perceptions and Behavioral and Response to AI Content

Consumer perception plays a vital role in determining the credibility, acceptance, and effectiveness of artificial intelligence generated business content. In the study of Castelo, Bos, and Lehmann (2021), they found that the individuals tend to be more receptive to artificial intelligence generated outputs in functional, analytical, and data-driven tasks than in emotional or moral contexts. This finding suggests that consumers perceive artificial intelligence as more competent in delivering objective information, performing routine tasks, and optimizing operational efficiency, while remaining skeptical of its capacity to handle emotionally nuanced or ethically sensitive communication. As a result, artificial intelligence is often viewed as better suited for informational and transactional communication, such as product descriptions, service updates, and technical support, rather than persuasive messaging, brand storytelling, or relationship-building activities. This distinction highlights the importance of strategically aligning artificial intelligence deployment with task characteristics to maximize credibility and user acceptance.

In the study of Araujo, Helberger, Kruikemeier, and de Vreese (2020) they observed that algorithm-driven personalization significantly enhances user engagement by delivering tailored content that aligns with individual preferences, behaviors, and consumption patterns. However, this increased relevance simultaneously raises concerns related to data





being collected and analyzed, leading to the heightened perceptions of intrusion and loss of autonomy. These privacy-related anxieties can undermine trust and negatively affect the perceived credibility of artificial intelligence generated communication particularly when personalization lacks transparency or explicit user consent. Consequently, businesses must carefully balance personalization benefits with ethical data practices and transparent disclosure to sustain consumer confidence.

Building on these insights, according to the study of Haenlein and Kaplan in 2021, they emphasized that organizations should adopt a hybrid form of communication strategies that integrates artificial intelligence efficiency with human creativity and emotional intelligence. While artificial intelligence offers scalability, consistency and speed, human communicators provide empathy, contextual understanding, and narrative depth that are essential for trust-building and emotional resonance. By combining technological capabilities with human oversight and creativity, business can deliver communication that is both operationally efficient and relationally meaningful. Such hybrid models not only enhance message credibility but also foster stronger emotional connections, enabling organizations to navigate consumer expectations more effectively in increasingly automated communication environments.

According to the study of Kumar, Dixit, Javalgi, and Dass (2021), they highlighted that the artificial intelligence driven communication enhances consumers' experience when aligned with ethical principles and transparency. Effective communication strategies increasingly depend on the capabilities of artificial intelligence with trust building mechanisms. Verma, Sharma, and Sheth (2021) found that trust mediates the relationship between AI usage and





consumer engagement, indicating that AI-based communication fails to achieve desired effective business outcomes without sufficient trust. Kaplan and Haenlein (2020) similarly argued that organizations should adopt human-centered AI communication models that emphasize emotional connection and authenticity, ensuring alignment between technological capabilities and corporate communication goals. Supporting this perspective, McLean and Osei-Frimpong (2024) concluded that AI-generated communication is most effective when supported by human oversight to ensure accuracy, empathy, and ethical compliance, thereby strengthening trust and credibility

Perceived Usefulness (PU) and Ease of Use (PEOU)

The implementation of AI in organizational communication involves a fine line between efficiency and trust in the hands of human beings. Dwivedi et al. (2021) state that the successful implementation of AI-powered communication tools is not just a functional design issue, but instead it is profound in its core of perceived usefulness, ease of use, and systemic trust.

To help businesses transcend the implementation stage and proceed to the real stage of user acceptance, AI systems should be designed in a way that can be seen and ethically sound. The perception of an AI tool as a trustworthy ally instead of a black box will result in more users





adopting an AI tool into their routine workflows. This change is essential because AI has been reshaping the business environment since it automatizes sophisticated content development and optimizes operational performance, enabling business organizations to stay afloat in an ever more digital market.

In addition to basic automation, the strategic importance of artificial intelligence is its potential to enhance the accuracy and the emotional appeal of organizational communications. As Davenport et al. (2020) emphasize, AI-based technologies can help companies to develop data-centric messages that would massively increase the effectiveness of marketing and the entire productivity of the company by extracting patterns, which would otherwise remain invisible to human eyes. This allows companies to transition towards hyper-personalized communication instead of generic broadcasting so that each message is custom made to the needs and behaviors of the target audience. The actual power of these tools however is not gauged by the output but the confidence that the user has in the logic behind the technology. Unless the users have a clear insight into the methods by which the AI can reach its conclusions they may not be willing to fully trust the technology, which could hamper the potential of the technology to transform the firm.

Shin (2021) suggests that explainable AI (XAI) systems are the key to filling this gap in confidence as a necessary part of the modern business integration. XAI turns the black box of traditional AI into a transparent, responsible entity because it offers a user with a clear, interpretable view of the process of how an algorithmic decision is reached. This transparency encourages a feeling of impartiality and trustworthiness which is necessary in upholding ethics in professional communication. When the stakeholders are able to perceive the why of the strategy created by AI, they will be much more satisfied with the system and the outputs provided by the





system will be regarded with a lot more credibility. It is this transparency that ultimately makes AI an acceptable and essential part of the process of streamlining and legitimizing business communication in the present-day context.

The nature of the application of AI in the business setting greatly depends on the presumption that the user feels that the technology will offer a relative benefit over the conventional processes. Hua et al. (2025) further suggest that the perceived usefulness of AI-generated content is frequently associated with its capacity to handle a large amount of consumer data in order to provide marketing messages that are hyper-personalized in real-time, which would not be achievable with the help of manual work only. This is the direct result of the efficiency that then has an effect on the operational agility of small and medium enterprises especially the food and beverage industry where swift adaptability to consumer trends is a necessity.

The integration of those tools is, however, effective only in the case the interface is user-friendly; according to You et al., (2023), when the perceived ease of use is low and the tools are too complex technically, the business owners will not accept the technology despite its possible advantages, and, in this regard, AI platforms should be user-friendly.

In addition, the ease of use and long-term trust relationship is mediated by black box nature of the algorithmic processes. Gursoy et al. (2019) indicate that the more easily users navigate and comprehend the AI tools, the less anxiety they develop in relation to automated decision-making, which further makes them more willing to use the system in performing essential communication tasks. This accessibility of communication builds a feeling of control which is a precondition of a trusted brand voice. Regarding digital transformation, the perceived usefulness of AI, as suggested by Algarni et al., (2023) is not speed per se, but the quality of the augmentation that AI offers to





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human creativity. As AI is seen as a productive partner and not a substitute, it would become clear to stakeholders that the new technology is useful in creating true brand narratives.

Lastly, AI-generated content is perceived to be useful more and more in terms of ethical reliability and accuracy. Kankanhalli et al. (2019) underline that the usefulness of AI systems in business communication is critically low in cases when the outputs that are generated need too much human intervention to eliminate errors or biases. To be considered really useful in a work-related environment, a technology should show extremely high rates of consistency and compatibility with organization values. Thus, the simplicity of the use should go beyond the first generation of content to incorporate the simplicity of checking and revising the AI outputs.

The perceived value of AI will eventually be determined by how much of the trust paradox is overcome in the CAMANAVA area as the business world continues to seek ways to sustain high standards of communication and lower the cognitive burden on the human operators.





CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

Research Design

The research employs a quantitative descriptive-correlational research design to study how the perceived credibility and transparency of AI-generated content influence the communication strategies of coffee shop owners and managers. The quantitative method is used to reliably convert subjective perceptions of users into numerical data, providing an opportunity to objectively evaluate the influence of AI-driven communication on business strategies. The application of structured survey instruments enables the researchers to discover patterns and determine the strength of the relationship between the identified variables within a rigorous statistical framework.

The descriptive aspect of the design is oriented toward the profiling of the coffee shops and food establishments in the CAMANAVA region, as well as establishing the current levels of credibility and algorithmic transparency as perceived by the respondents. The study focuses on a correlational analysis to examine the significant relationship that exists between the respondents' perceptions and their actual communication strategies.





This design examines the connection between the constructs of the Source Credibility Model, specifically Expertise and Trustworthiness, alongside Perceived Algorithmic Transparency, and their impact on the respondents' communication strategies regarding Quality of Content, Message Consistency, and Audience Engagement. This provides the necessary contextual background to understand the environment in which AI-generated content is being implemented, offering a basis for how different business structures view the integration of technology in light of recorded credibility challenges in local trade.

The study establishes the level at which business characteristics and perceptions are related to the credibility of AI as a means of communication. The outcomes of this correlational analysis provide the empirical basis for developing a strategic marketing framework aimed at fostering trust and maintaining professional reliability in AI-based business communications within the CAMANAVA area.

Research Locale

The study will be conducted in the CAMANAVA region which involves Caloocan, Malabon, Navotas and Valenzuela cities in Metro Manila, Philippines. The area is a strategic research location since it has a high concentration of micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs), and an exciting food and beverage industry in particular. Being a new urban market, CAMANAVA is an ever-changing point of convergence between the old values of business and the fast digitalization. This selection of this locale is based on the growing popularity of the artificial use of AI- generated content within local coffee





shops as a way to control social media interactions, automated customer service, and advertising marketing. These institutions are seriously shifting to AI-enhanced communication approaches as they manage the challenges of retaining customers. This is a good testing environment where the impact of automated messaging on consumer trust and perceived credibility is tested critically.

The localized nature of the business environment around which the research centers by targeting this particular geographical cluster can capture the subtlety of a localized environment where digital innovation is combined with customer interaction of high frequency. The coffee shop industry of CAMANAVA will make it possible to conduct a specific evaluation of the effect of artificial intelligence on the effectiveness of communication. Finally, the results will provide replicable information on the usage patterns of the AI technologies in the business centres of the Philippines.

Population and Sampling

The target population for this study comprises coffee shop owners and managers who work in the area of CAMANAVA. These people have been chosen since they are the main respondents, because they were directly involved in the strategic marketing decision, business communication, and customer relationship management. Their first order experience endows them with the requisite view to determine the ability of artificial intelligence to integrate localized commercial operations.





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The minimum sample size that the study will use to achieve statistical reliability will be 60 to 80 respondents. This is in line with recommendations of Labajová (2023). This is an adequate sample size to uphold the validity of the quantitative measurement and offer a meaningful sample of the trend of digital communication in the industry.

The study utilizes purposive sampling because it focuses on the selection of participants having eligibility criteria to address the research objectives. The conditions are that respondents to qualify, should be operating or owning a coffee shop within the Caloocan, Malabon, Navotas or Valenzuela that is actively using the digital platforms to advertise their products. Moreover, respondents need to have written experience or acquaintance with the tools of AI-generated content, so gathered information must be informed by professional judgment.

Research Instrument

The primary data collection tool for this study is a structured survey questionnaire, which will be developed in a systematic manner with the help of the adaptation of the Source Credibility Theory and available academic sources on AI-based business communication. The instrument uses a 4-point Likert scale with the following ranges to guarantee quality data and statistical accuracy; strongly disagree, disagree, agree, and strongly agree. Such a forced-choice format has been naturally chosen to avoid the influence of a neutral or undecided bias and make the respondents take a decisive position in their recognition of AI-generated content.





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The instrument is divided into three specialized areas that are to help obtain a balanced overview of the research variables. Section A will collect the profile and business information of the respondent including vital demographic and business information like the type of ownership, size of business, and the frequency of the use of AI. Section B deals with the main constructs of SCT, where Expertises, Trustworthiness, and Algorithmic Transparency Using and Behavioral Intention are measured in terms of specific behavioral statements. Lastly, it is Section C where the critical variables of Credibility are measured in the expertise, transparency and algorithmic transparency of AI-generated communications in the business situation.

In order to ensure the academic rigour of the instrument, the instrument goes through a formal validation process which includes review by research advisers and subject matter experts so as to validate content. After the approval of experts, a pilot test is done on a small sample of coffee shop managers to determine how clear and internally consistent the questions are. This pilot testing will enable the researchers to narrow down on the language and design of the questionnaire, such that the final instrument is reliable and efficient in collecting the data that is needed to make the strategic communication recommendations.

Data Collection Procedure





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The researchers will first secure permission from selected coffee shop establishments within the CAMANAVA area. After obtaining approval, the researchers will approach potential respondents and explain the purpose and objectives of the study. The questionnaires will be distributed either personally or through an online platform such as Google Forms, depending on the respondents' availability and preference. Respondents will be given adequate time to read and answer the questionnaire.

The researchers will ensure that all respondents clearly understand the instructions and that participation is voluntary. Once the responses have been collected, the questionnaires will be reviewed for completeness before proceeding to data coding and analysis.

Data Analysis and Treatment

To provide a strict assessment of the research objectives, a 4-point Likert scale was employed. This scale was chosen to avoid neutral responses and ensure a definitive assessment of the respondents' experiences. The weighted means derived from the survey are interpreted using the following guide: 4(Strongly agree) 3(agree) 2(disagree) 1(strongly agree)

Ethical Considerations

The ethical principles will be used to inform the research process so that the dignity and security of the entire participants are preserved. The research will be voluntary, and





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the respondents will be given a clear outline of the research intention and how they will be involved in the research before any data collection is done. Each participant is entitled to the absolute right to discontinue the study at any point without any adverse effects or the possibility to justify the choice.

The researchers will also observe the principles of anonymity and confidentiality to ensure that the data remains professional and safe at the same time. The final report or further academic presentation will not reveal any personal names or identities of the particular business or proprietary information. Any information will be examined and reported in the aggregate form, so that the answer of specific coffee shop owners or managers of the CAMANAVA area cannot be tracked.

All the information obtained, according to the Data Privacy Act of 2012, will only be used academically. To ensure that no data will be accessed by unauthorized individuals or there is no data leakage, digital data shall be stored in secure and password-protected files that are only accessible to the research team. At the end of the study and its successful defense, all raw data such as physical and electronic data will be destroyed or eliminated permanently to guarantee the privacy of all respondents in the long term.





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PART I: Business Profile of the Respondents

Direction: Please put a check mark (/) in the box that corresponds to your answer.

1. Years of AI usage:

☐ Less than 1 year

☐ 1–3 years

☐ 4–6 years

☐ 7 years and above

2. Business Size (Number of Employees):

☐ Micro (1–9)

☐ Small (10–99)

☐ Medium (100–199)

3. Duration of AIGC utilization in business operations;

☐ Less than 6 months

☐ 6 months – 1 year

☐ More than 1 year

4. Frequency of AI-Generated Content Utilization:

☐ Daily

☐ Weekly

☐ Monthly

☐ Rarely





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PART II: Level of credibility of AI-generated business content

Direction: Please rate your level of agreement with each statement by placing a check mark (/) in the appropriate column using the scale below.

Legend:

(4) Strongly Agree

(3) Agree

(2) Disagree

(1) Strongly Disagree

Statement	4 (SA)	3 (A)	2 (D)	1 (SD)
Expertise				
1. AI provides accurate information regarding coffee shop trends.				
2. AI-generated content demonstrates a high level of knowledge about the industry.				
3. The suggestions made by the AI appear professional.				
4. AI-generated suggestions are realistic for business applications.				
5. The AI quickly provides relevant solutions when I ask for ways to promote my coffee shop.				





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Trustworthiness

1. I perceive AI-generated content as trustworthy.				
2. I can rely on the AI-generated content to provide unbiased marketing suggestions.				
3. The content generated by the AI aligns with my brand's values.				
4. AI-generated content can be trusted for customer communication.				
5. AI-generated business content provides dependable communication support.				





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PART III: Perceived Algorithmic Transparency of AI generated business content

Direction: Please rate your level of agreement with each statement by placing a check mark (/) in the appropriate column using the scale below.

Legend:

(4) Strongly Agree

(3) Agree

(2) Disagree

(1) Strongly Disagree

Algorithmic Transparency	4 (SA)	3 (A)	2 (D)	1 (SD)
1. It is clear to me how the AI decides what content to generate.				
2. I understand why the AI produces specific results based on my inputs/prompts.				
3. The way the AI functions is not unfamiliar to me.				
4. The way the AI creates its suggestions is easy to follow.				
5. I know the limitations and weak spots of the AI tool I use.				





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PART IV: Technology Acceptance (TAM 3)

Direction: Please rate your level of agreement with each statement by placing a check mark (/) in the appropriate column using the scale below.

Legend:

(4) Strongly Agree

(3) Agree

(2) Disagree

(1) Strongly Disagree

Perceived Usefulness (PU)	4 (SA)	3 (A)	2 (D)	1 (SD)
1. Using AI enhances my productivity in managing my coffee shop.				
2. AI tools help me reach my marketing goals more effectively.				
3. I find AI tools useful in my daily business operations.				
4. AI tools assist me in identifying new business opportunities for my coffee shop.				
5. Relying on AI helps me handle unexpected business challenges more effectively				





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Perceived Ease of Use (PEU)				
1. Interacting with AI tools does not require a lot of mental effort.				
2. I find it easy to get the AI to do what I want it to do.				
3. Learning to operate AI tools is easy for me.				
4. I can access and use the functions of AI tools without any complicated setup.				
5. I do not need to seek help from others to figure out how to use AI tools properly.				





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PART V: Level of Communication Strategies

Direction: Please rate your level of agreement with each statement by placing a check mark (/) in the appropriate column using the scale below.

Legend:

(4) Strongly Agree

(3) Agree

(2) Disagree

(1) Strongly Disagree

Quality of Content	4 (SA)	3 (A)	2 (D)	1 (SD)
1. AI-generated content I use is clear to understand and relevant.				
2. I ensure that the AI-generated content I use meets quality standards before posting.				
3. Provides reliable information to customers.				
4. The AI organizes the text well (using good spacing or emojis). Thus, it is easy for online readers to scan.				
5. The AI quickly gives me content that fits current trends or seasons.				





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Message Consistency

1. The messages I share using AI align with my business values.				
2. My communication with customers remains consistent even when using AI.				
3. Helps me to deliver messages across different platforms.				
4. My customers never get confused by the information the AI helps me write.				
5. The AI content sounds like it was written by a real staff member of my coffee shop.				

Audience Engagement

1. Helps increase customer engagement.				
2. Responds quickly to my customers' inquiries.				
3. Encourages customers' feedback and interaction.				
4. The captions or promos written by the AI make customers want to visit our shop or buy our coffee.				
5. The AI writes captions using language and trends that local coffee lovers easily understand.				





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